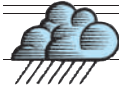


The Washington Post

Prices may vary in areas outside metropolitan Washington.

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Shower 67/38 • Tomorrow: Partly sunny 56/47 B6

Democracy Dies in Darkness

SATURDAY, MARCH 22, 2025 • \$4

Youngkin's effort to hire hits roadbumps

Va. has jobs, but fired federal workers' wants, state needs may not meet

BY LAURA VOZZELLA
AND GREGORY S. SCHNEIDER

RICHMOND — Ashley Ranalli finally landed her dream job as a National Park Service ranger in October, after a decade of volunteering and working part-time for the federal agency.

Talk about bad timing. Ranalli, 41, was among the thousands of probationary workers fired last month by the Trump administration. So the Fredericksburg resident did what Virginia Gov. Glenn Youngkin (R) has recommended at public events around the state, including in Virginia Beach on Tuesday and Richmond on Wednesday: she went looking for work among the many thousands of openings in Virginia, using a state portal the governor has been touting.

Ranalli, whom Sen. Mark R. Warner (D-Virginia) invited to the president's address to Congress earlier this month, came away skeptical of Youngkin's "Virginia Has Jobs" mantra.

"What the governor means is, like, fast food jobs," said Ranalli, who made \$68,000 a year at Fredericksburg & Spotsylvania National Military Park and so far is not among the probationary workers being rehired under a judge's ruling. "They're just being tricky with the wording — 'Yes, we have jobs available,' but it's not going to be commensurate. What fast-food job is going to give me \$68,000 and benefits? That's not real."

Youngkin's effort to walk a careful line on the Trump administration's efforts to drastically cut the federal workforce — he casts himself as both pro-Trump and pro-worker — seems to be running up against a hard economic reality. In

SEE JOBS ON A7

A victory for Sudan's military



IDREES ALI/AP

Sudanese soldiers celebrate after recapturing the presidential palace in Khartoum from the Rapid Support Forces paramilitary. It was a highly symbolic win for government forces in the nation's civil war. **Story, A10**

Musk's ties to China complicate his DOGE role

BY CATE CADELL

When news broke that a Friday Pentagon meeting with Elon Musk might include details of U.S. war plans for China, the administration — including President Donald Trump — mobilized to deny it, underscoring the tech billionaire's precarious position: dependent on the favor of both Trump and Beijing.

U.S. officials said before the meeting that it was anticipated Musk would be read in on a number of classified topics, including threats posed by Beijing. News of the briefing was first

Pentagon meeting raises concerns about security, business conflicts

reported by the New York Times.

President Donald Trump and Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth were quick to deny the reports, with Trump dismissing them as "fake news." Musk responded by calling the Times story "pure propaganda" and said he looked forward to the prosecution of whoever leaked the information.

But the official response underscored the extreme sensitivities surrounding Musk's role as head of the U.S. DOGE Service and growing concerns over how his outsized influence in Washington may conflict with his longstanding business interests in China.

"Certainly you wouldn't show that to a businessman," Trump said, speaking about the Pentagon's plans for a potential conflict with China. "Elon has businesses in China, and he would be susceptible perhaps to that," he told reporters at the White House on Friday.

Lawmakers and analysts warn that Beijing could exploit Musk's connections, particularly as China ramps up preparations to take Taiwan by force if necessary.

"It cuts both ways with Musk. On the one hand, he's already cleared into several sensitive programs, given the work of SpaceX and the importance of Starlink. ... On the other hand, he has significant business interests in China. He's advanced Chinese Communist Party talking points

SEE MUSK ON A14

Musk's conflict of interest: Trump says war plan off-limits. **A14**

JERRY V. WILSON 1928-2025

D.C. police chief was a central player in a tumultuous period

BY PETER HERMANN

Jerry V. Wilson, who spent a quarter-century on the Metropolitan Police Department, the final five years as chief, a post from which he modernized and expanded the force, put women on patrol for the first time, hired more African Americans and eased racial tensions in the aftermath of the 1968 riots, died March 11 at an assisted-living center in Gainesville, Virginia. He was 96.

His son Kevin Wilson confirmed the death but did not provide a specific cause.

Mr. Wilson was a central player in a tumultuous and transformative period in the District's history that encompassed the civil rights movement, anti-Vietnam War protests and the run-up to home rule.

He made his most important early stand as the department's field commander in 1968, balking at political pressure from the city and federal leaders and prohibiting his officers from firing at looters and rioters during the riots that followed the assassina-

tion of the Rev. Martin Luther King Jr.

His actions during the riots "saved the city," said the Rev. Philip R. Newell Jr., then the executive director of the Protestant council of churches in the District, based out of the New York Avenue Presbyterian Church.

Newell was at the table with the mayor and other leaders when police policies and tactics were debated. He said there were strong demands from White business owners for police to take a hard stance on the outbreak of violence in the aftermath of King's death. The orders from Mayor Walter E. Washington were to not shoot.

Mr. Wilson stood his ground at the epicenter, commanding his force from 14th and U streets as buildings burned around him. Nearly 14,000 federal troops helped quell the riots in D.C., which left wide swaths of the city devastated, a dozen people dead, mostly in fires, and thousands were fatally shot by police during the

SEE WILSON ON A6



Wilson



PAUL POPPER/POPPERFOTO/GETTY IMAGES

Alberto Santos Dumont, who Brazilians say made the first heavier-than-air flight, in 1906.

Brazil's nationalist flight of fancy?

Despite academic consensus, Wright brothers' first comes under attack

BY TERRENCE MCCOY
IN PETRÓPOLIS, BRAZIL

Who invented the airplane?

Questions don't get much simpler. But in Brazil and the United States, the answer you'll get isn't likely to be the same.

In 1903, U.S. schoolchildren are taught, the Wright brothers piloted their Wright Flyer into the air in Kitty Hawk, N.C., and soared into the history books.

Brazilians hear a different story: that the true

inventor of the airplane was Alberto Santos Dumont — commonly described here as "the father of aviation."

For more than a century, ever since he steered his 14-Bis into the Paris sky in 1906, the country has been trying indefatigably to give their man his due, regardless of the academic consensus. Santos Dumont's mustachioed visage has graced Brazilian currency. One of Rio de Janeiro's airports is named after him. A replica of his airplane, piloted by a Santos Dumont look-alike,

SEE PLANE ON A11

Migrant rights agencies closing

DHS SAYS 3 OFFICES IMPEDED ITS MISSION

Watchdogs advocated, investigated complaints

BY MARIA SACCHETTI
AND ELLIE SILVERMAN

The Department of Homeland Security is eradicating three internal watchdog agencies that investigated complaints and advocated for immigrants, calling the watchdogs "roadblocks" to immigration enforcement, a spokeswoman said Friday.

The department has ordered a "reduction in force" for the Office for Civil Rights and Civil Liberties, the Office of the Immigration Detention Ombudsman and the Office of the Citizenship and Immigration Services Ombudsman, essentially eliminating them, according to DHS spokeswoman Tricia McLaughlin. She alleged that the three offices "have obstructed immigration enforcement by adding bureaucratic hurdles and undermining DHS's mission."

Taken together, the agencies had about 300 employees, a small share of the estimated 260,000 workers at the DHS. They handled thousands of complaints about the immigration system, including detention conditions, the care of migrant children, and delays in processing green-card and citizenship applications. Their reports informed House

SEE DHS ON A6

Social Security: Acting head backs off on argument to close agency. **A7**

Judge scolds government over removal of migrants

BY SILVIA FOSTER-FRAU
AND JUSTIN JOUVENAL

A federal judge on Friday expressed doubts about the Trump administration's use of a wartime power to deport alleged Venezuelan gang members, while also grilling a government attorney about whether officials had disregarded his order not to do so.

James E. Boasberg, chief justice for the U.S. District Court for the District of Columbia, acknowledged that the president has broad authority over foreign policy and deportations. But he said the Trump administration's use of the Alien Enemies Act to abruptly send more than 100 Venezuelans to a prison in El Salvador without a hearing or assessment seemed "problematic and concerning."

"I agree it is an unprecedented and expanded use of the act," the judge said at an afternoon hearing.

Before deputy assistant attorney general Drew Ensing had a chance to address the court,

SEE JUDGE ON A4

Impeachment: Trump's base seeds the ground to degrade judiciary. **A4**

Another target: Administration again seeks to disqualify judge. **A8**

IN THE NEWS

Life with 'Grandpa' Trump In online videos, the president's granddaughter Kai presents a teenager's view of the MAGA universe. **A3**

Holding out for a hero Democrats, frustrated by Republicans' efforts to slash the government under President Donald Trump, are looking for someone to fight back. **A5**

THE NATION **USDA canceled** \$500 million in food bank deliveries as groups struggle to meet demand. **A2** **This week's** trove of Kennedy assassination records is a feast for historians. **A8**

THE WORLD **El Salvador's** Nayib Bukele is holding deportees for Trump. But what are his motives? **A9** **London's** Heathrow Airport was partially reopened after a crippling cut in power. **A11**

THE ECONOMY **Amazon argued** that the nation's top consumer product safety commission is unconstitutional. **A12** **Tesla owners** traded in their vehicles at a record rate amid backlash to CEO Elon Musk's role in the Trump administration. **A13**

THE REGION **Maryland** health officials reported two more measles cases stemming from international travel and warned of possible exposures. **B1** **ICE detained** a Venezuelan couple for a second time this month after a federal judge ordered their release. **B1**

STYLE **On Broadway**, the musicals "Operation Mincemeat" and "Buena Vista Social Club" truly sing. **C1** **SPORTS** **Shyanne Sellers** hopes to end her women's basketball career at Maryland with a deep NCAA Tournament run. **D1**

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The Washington Post
Year 148, No. 54163

